

Everyone Else • 12/39 • Malik al-Ashtar

The Man in the Market. Imam Ali wrote Malik a letter about how to govern. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

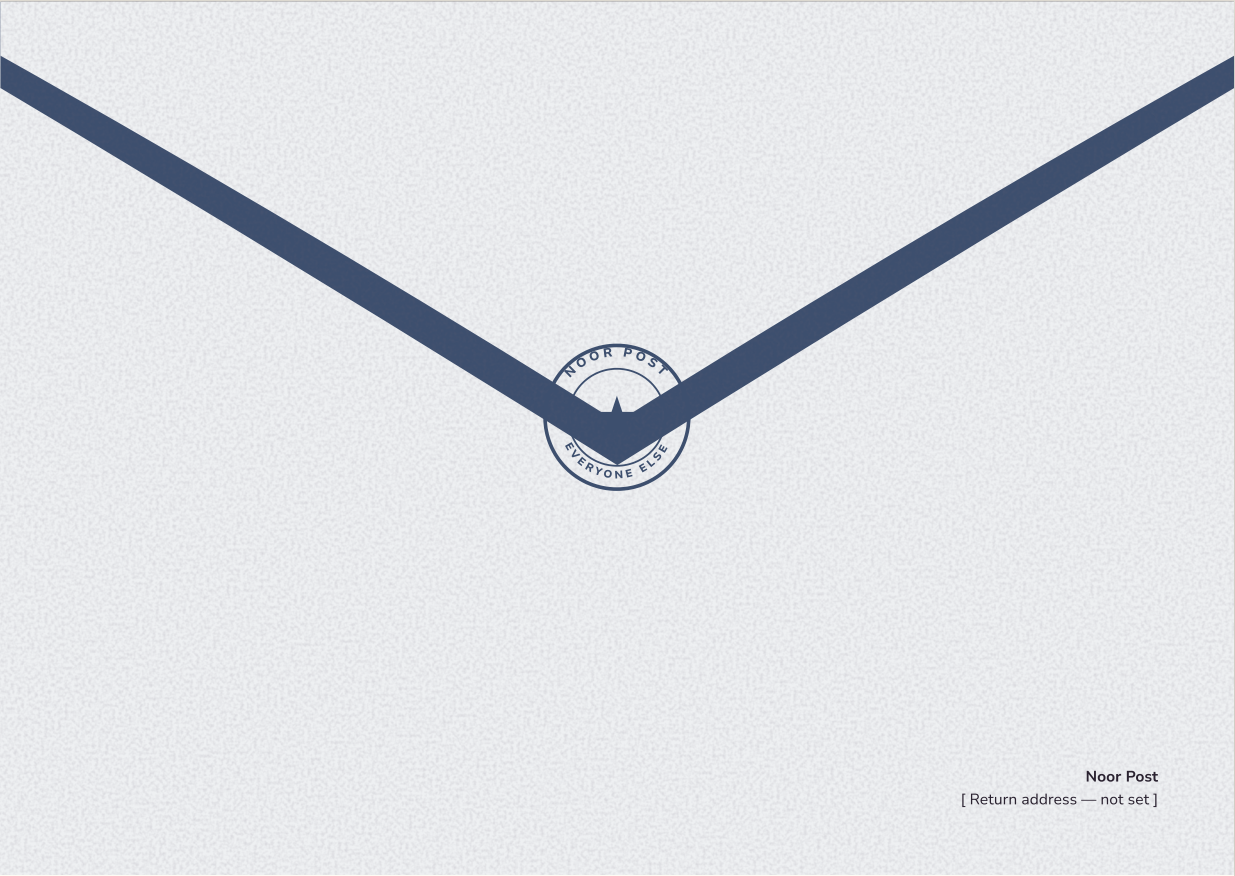
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Imam Ali wrote Malik a
letter about how to
govern.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE · MALIK
AL-ASHTAR · INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

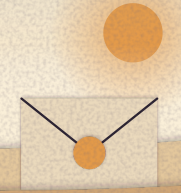
1 · THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

Malik al-Ashtar

- **Who he was.** A commander from Kufa, and one of Imam Ali's most senior military figures. His name comes from an injury to his eye — *al-Ashtar*.
- **What he was known for.** Command, at the largest scale available in that empire, and a reputation among his enemies that is recorded by his enemies.
- **The letter.** Imam Ali appointed him governor of Egypt and sent him with a long letter of instructions — how to treat the people, the poor, the army, his own officials. **It is in Nahj al-Balagha and it is read now as a document about government, by people with no connection to any of this.**
- **What is in it.** Instructions to keep the ordinary people first, to be reachable, to be suspicious of advisers who flatter, and to never let anger decide anything.
- **What happened.** He never took up the post. He died on the road to Egypt, and the accounts say he was poisoned before he arrived.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Imam Ali wrote Malik a letter about how to govern.*

He died on the road to Egypt, before reaching it. The accounts hold that he was killed at the instigation of those he was being sent to replace.

The Man in the Market



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- If you had seen him coming down a street you would have moved. He was a soldier, he was enormous, and he commanded armies. People who fought against him wrote about him afterwards the way you write about weather.

○ Was he scary?

- He was the most frightening man in his army, and his army knew it.

- One day he is walking through a market in Kufa in ordinary clothes. Nothing to say who he is. And a man at a stall — bored, showing off, playing to the people around him — throws something at him. Rubbish. Something off the floor.

○ At him? On purpose?

- On purpose, for a laugh, at a stranger he thought was nobody.

○ What did he do?

- Nothing. He kept walking. Did not turn round, did not say anything, did not look for him.

○ Really?

THE MAN IN THE MARKET • CONTINUED

- Really. And then somebody in that market grabbed the man's arm and told him who he had just done that to.

◦ **Oh no.**

- The man went after him through the street to find him and apologise, and found him in the masjid, praying.

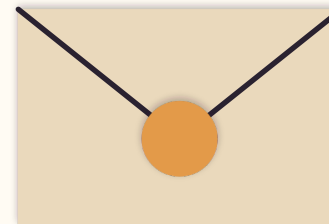
◦ **What would you say to him? Say it out loud now.**

- And here is what he had gone in there for. He had gone in to ask forgiveness for the man who had thrown it — because he had worked out that the man was going to be terrified when he found out who he was, and he wanted that dealt with before it started.
- He was praying for him before the man knew he needed it.
- This is the person Imam Ali trusted with Egypt. He wrote him a letter about how to govern it — pages of it, about how to treat people who cannot do anything to you — and the reason we still read that letter is that it was written to someone who did not need it explained. It reads like advice. It was closer to a description.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**He could have done
anything. He kept
walking.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 12/39

IMAM ALI SAID

**“The most capable of
pardoning is he who is the
most powerful to punish.”**

Imam Ali

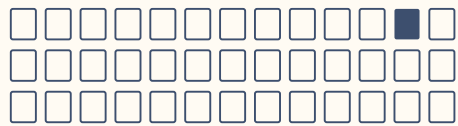


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

**The person who could punish the most
is the one best able to forgive.**

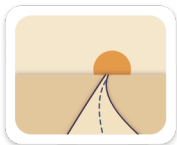
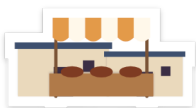
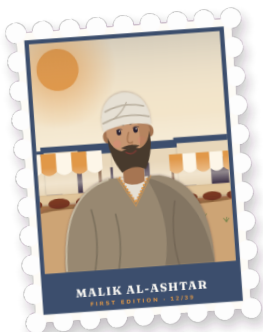
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

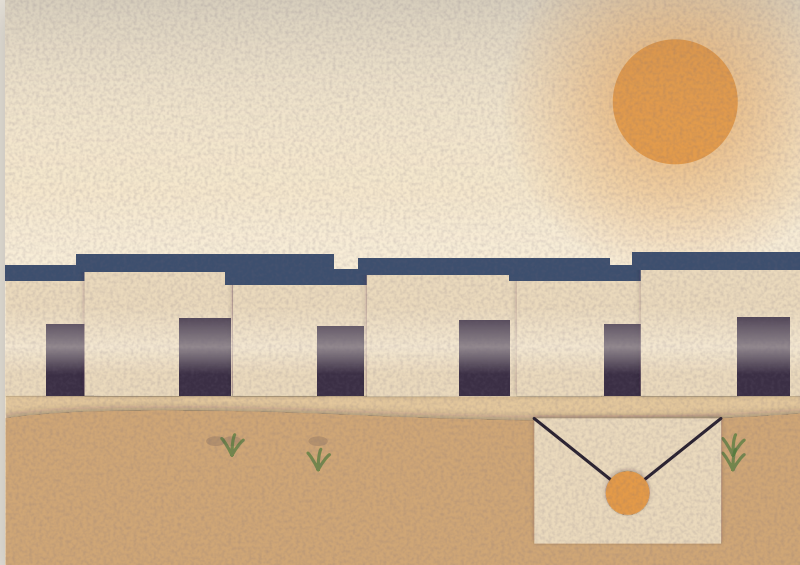
Nahj al-Balagha, Saying 52. Translated by Sayed Ali Reza.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Malik al-Ashtar





**We opened this one
together.**

- _____
- _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
